Dinshaw accused Sorabji of being a banker with a ‘spirit of speculation’ and also cast aspersions on his conduct which he claimed was inconsistent with the integrity of a banker. Rustum Masani, was inducted into the bank by Sir Dinshaw, and there was the inevitable clash with Sorabji. It ended with both of them resigning. In the end, only Masani’s resignation was accepted.

Book II on Central Banking in India, which highlights the contribution of Sir Purshotamdas Thakurdas and Sir Chintaman Dwarkanath Deshmukh is in two parts. Part I is on Indian currency and finance and Part II deals with the RBI. Though we are here primarily concerned with Purshotamdas’s contribution to banking, in particular, his stellar role in the ratio debate, the campaign for a central bank, and subsequently as a Director of the RBI from its inception in 1935 till January 1957, Purshotamdas was truly a man for all seasons. He was also associated with the Central Bank of India and was one of the most active Directors of the Imperial Bank of India. He joined the Board of the Imperial Bank in July 1922 and till his resignation in December 1934 (just before the RBI was born), was one of its most active Directors. Details of Purshotamdas’s contributions in a variety of fields are brought out in the long Prologue to Book II as are details of C.D. Deshmukh’s multidimensional virtuosity. Civil servant, central banker, Union Finance Minister, educationist, institution builder, and social worker, Deshmukh left his impress on numerous institutions in India. This book is concerned with Deshmukh’s role as a central banker.

Part I deals with the rupee-ratio controversy (the fixation of the exchange value of the rupee vis-à-vis sterling and through it with other currencies was popularly known as ratio) which excited many passions in the first few decades of the last century and the great battle Purshotamdas waged over this question against a formidable combination of British vested interests. Purshotamdas wanted the rupee to be pegged at 1s 4d instead of 1s 6d which he felt was harming India’s economic interests. Around this question was to develop a crusade in which Purshotamdas was to play a leading role.

A brief historical background of Indian currency and exchange and the recommendations of important committees and commissions, which examined, among other things, the issues of an appropriate monetary standard and exchange rate for India introduces the subject of the exchange ratio. The Hilton Young Commission, (more properly the Royal